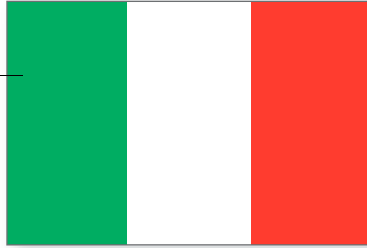


Italy

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** June 18, 1946 **Usage:** National

*Green was said
to be Napoleon's
favorite color*



The first vertical tricolor was used until 1814. It was readopted in 1861

Europe



Italy was a collection of city states, dukedoms, and monarchies before it became a unified nation in 1861. Italy became a republic in 1946.

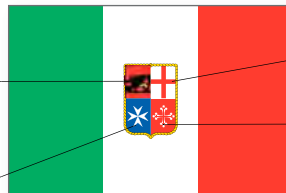
The Italian tricolor comes from the standard designed by Napoleon during the Italian campaign of 1796. The coloring was influenced by the French *Tricolore*, at first appearing in horizontal bands. The vertical tricolor was introduced in 1798, but was only used until 1814. It was re-introduced when the new Kingdom of Italy was formed in

1861. When the monarchy ended in 1946, the coat of arms of the House of Savoy was removed from the flag. The present flag was officially adopted in 1946.

ITALIAN CIVIL ENSIGN

The most famous seafaring states of ancient Italy are commemorated in the quarters of the civil ensign.

ITALIAN CIVIL ENSIGN



*The winged lion of
St. Mark represents Venice*

*The Maltese cross
recalls Amalfi*

*The Cross of St. George
represents Genoa*

*The Pisan cross
stands for Pisa*